

Nikolas E. Webster, Ph.D.

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Department of Linguistics, University of California, Santa Cruz
1156 High St. Santa Cruz, CA 95060

EDUCATION

- 2020 – 2026 **University of California, Santa Cruz**
Ph.D. in Linguistics
Advisor and dissertation chair: [Ivy Sichel](#)
Committee: [Maziar Toosarvandani](#), [Mia Gong](#) (internal), [Karlos Arregi](#) (external)
- 2015 – 2019 **New York University**
summa cum laude
B.A. in Linguistics, with honors
Minors in Korean Language and Studio Art

Non-degree programs

- 2022 CreteLing Summer School at the University of Crete in Rethymno, Greece.
- 2017 HU German Language Academy at Humboldt Universität in Berlin, Germany.
- 2016 Korean Language Institute (KLI) at Yonsei University in Seoul, South Korea.

PAPERS

Journal articles

- revise & resubmit [Webster, N.](#) Roots introduce low internal arguments.
- 2026 Cartner, M., M. Kogan, [N. Webster](#) (co-first); M. Wagers & I. Sichel. Subject islands do not reduce to construction-specific discourse function. *Cognition: International Journal of Cognitive Science*, 271. 106467. Elsevier. DOI: [10.1016/j.cognition.2026.106467](https://doi.org/10.1016/j.cognition.2026.106467).

Conference proceedings

- 2025 [Webster, N.](#) Acategorical licensing of internal arguments in Korean. In Barrie, M. (ed.), *Proceedings of the 18th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics*. MITWPL. 249–259.

Edited volumes

- 2025 [Webster, N.](#), Y. Kiper, H. Wang, & L. Lyu (eds). *Proceedings of the 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL41)*. Cascadilla Press.

Dissertation

- 2026 [Webster, N.](#) *Loanwords in syntax: the projection of internal arguments*. University of California, Santa Cruz dissertation. [Available soon on ProQuest].

PRESENTATIONS

Refereed conference talks

- 2026 **Webster, N.** Sino-Korean loanword integration: consequences for the morpho-syntactic interface. *Talk at the 28th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (SICOGG28)*. Chungnam National University, Daejeon, South Korea. Aug 10-12.
- 2026 **Webster, N.** Sino-Korean loanword integration: consequences for the morpho-syntactic interface. *Talk at the 33rd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference (JK33)*. University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC), Champaign, IL. August 6-9.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** Sino-Korean predicates on the nature of syntactic categorization. *Talk at 49. Österreichische Linguistiktagung (ÖLT49): Workshop on Native vs. Borrowed Word Formation in Synchrony and Diachrony*. Klagenfurt University, Klagenfurt, Austria. Dec 5-8.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** The syntactic and semantic introduction of internal arguments. *Talk at the 32nd Japanese/Korean Linguistics Conference (JK32)*. Cornell University, Ithaca, NY, USA. Jun 13-15.
- 2025 **Webster, N.,** M. Cartner, M. Kogan, M. Wagers, & I. Sichel. Information structure alone cannot account for subject islandhood: an experimental study. *Long talk at the 47th Annual Meeting of Generative Linguistics in the Old World (GLOW47)*. Goethe University, Frankfurt, Germany. Mar 25-27.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** Internal argument introduction in Korean complex predicates. *Talk at the 14th Workshop on Theoretical East Asian Linguistics (TEAL14)*. University of Southern California, Los Angeles, CA, USA. Mar 18-20.
- 2024 **Webster, N.** Acategorial licensing of internal arguments in Korean. *Talk at the 18th Workshop on Altaic Formal Linguistics and the 26th Seoul International Conference on Generative Grammar (WALF18 & SICOGG26 joint conference)*. Jeonbuk National University, Jeonju, South Korea. Aug 22-24.
- 2024 Cao, Y. & **N. Webster**. Head Movement as PF-Raising/Lowering in Swahili RCs. *Talk at the 55th Annual Conference on African Linguistics (ACAL55)*. McGill University, Montreal, QC, Canada. May 2-4.

Refereed conference posters

- 2025 **Webster, N.,** M. Cartner, M. Kogan, M. Wagers, & I. Sichel. Subject islands do not reduce to construction-specific discourse function. *Poster at the 56th Annual Meeting of the North East Linguistics Society (NELS56)*. New York University, New York, NY, USA. Oct 17-19.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** The syntactic and semantic introduction of internal arguments. *Poster at the 43rd West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics (WCCFL43)*. University of Washington, Seattle, WA, USA. Apr 25-27.
- 2025 M. Kogan, M. Cartner, **N. Webster**, M. Wagers, & I. Sichel. Subject islands are not caused by information structure clashes: cross-constructional evidence. *Poster at the 38th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP38)*. University of Maryland, College Park, MD, USA. Mar 27-29.

- 2024 **Webster, N.**, M. Kogan, M. Cartner, M. Wagers, & I. Sichel. Subject islands are not caused by information structure clashes: evidence from topicalization. *Poster at the 30th Meeting of Architectures and Mechanisms for Language Processing (AMLaP30)*. The University of Edinburgh, Edinburgh, Scotland. Sep 5-7.
- 2024 **Webster, N.**, H. Byun, & M. Wagers. Processing arguments in Korean nominal predicates. *Poster at the 37th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing (HSP37)*. University of Michigan, Ann Arbor, MI, USA. May 16-18.
- 2024 **Webster, N.** & Wagers, M. Processing thematic (mis)alignment in Korean nominals. *Poster at the 6th California Meeting on Psycholinguistics (CAMP6)*. Stanford University, Stanford, CA, USA. Jan 13-14.

Invited talks

- 2026 **Webster, N.** Classificatory incorporation in Korean and the syntax-semantics interface. *Syntax and Morphology Circle (SMircle)*. Stanford University, Stanford, CA, USA. May 15.
- 2026 **Webster, N.** Loanword integration and its consequences for the morpho-syntactic interface. *Commentary on the Latest Approaches to Syntax and Semantics in Illinois (claSSi)*. University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign (UIUC), Champaign, IL. Mar 31.
- 2026 **Webster, N.** Delayed argument saturation in Korean double ACC constructions. *Syntax and Semantics Circle*. UC Berkeley, Berkeley, CA, USA. Feb 13.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** Delayed argument saturation in Korean double ACC constructions. *S-Circle, a forum for syntax and semantics*. UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA, USA. Nov 7.
- 2025 Vasser, M., **N. Webster**, M. Kogan, I. Sichel, & M. Wagers. Does presuppositionality affect DP sub-extraction? *Linguistics Undergraduate Research Conference (LURC)*. UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA, USA. May 30.
- 2025 **Webster, N.** The internal arguments of Korean process nominals and complex predicates. *Workshop on Nominals and Nominalizations in Korean and Beyond* University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign, Champaign, IL, USA. May 9-10.
- 2025 Kogan, M., **Webster, N.**, Cartner, M., Wagers, M. & Sichel, I. Subject island effects cannot be reduced to information structure. *Linguistics at Santa Cruz (LASC)*. UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA, USA. Mar 10.
- 2024 **Webster, N.** Verbal material is not needed for argument structure: evidence from Korean. *S-Circle, a forum for syntax and semantics*. UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA, USA. Mar 11.
- 2023 **Webster, N.** On the argument structure of eventive nominals in Korean. *Syntax and Semantics Circle*. UC Berkeley, Berkeley, CA, USA. Oct 27.
- 2022 **Webster, N.** Nominal argument structure in Korean: an analysis of argument realization in non-derived nominals. *Linguistics Spring Research Symposium (LSRS)*. UC Santa Cruz, Santa Cruz, CA, USA. May 7.

PEDAGOGY CERTIFICATIONS

Arizona State University (ASU), with Coursera

in progress [TESOL Specialization](#), Professional Certificate. *150 hours of online professional training, covering pedagogical practices for ESL classrooms and theories of second language acquisition.*

The Teaching & Learning Center (TLC) at UC Santa Cruz

2025 [Equitable Course Design](#), Graduate Certificate. *A quarter-long, credit-awarding professional course covering evidence-based practices for designing courses that center student learning.*

2025 [Equity-Minded Mentoring](#), Graduate Certificate. *A quarter-long professional course exploring evidence-based strategies to support underrepresented mentees in research.*

2024 [Preparing for Inclusive Teaching](#), Graduate Certificate. *A day-long professional workshop on equity-minded learning outcomes, student motivation and sense of belonging.*

2022 [Teaching for Equity](#), Graduate Certificate. *A five-week professional development series covering issues of diversity, equity, and inclusion in higher education.*

2021 [Teaching as an Ethical Practice](#), Graduate Certificate. *An asynchronous, quarter-long course for TAs introducing professional ethics, with focus on educational equity and accessibility.*

Department of Linguistics at UC Santa Cruz

2020 – 2022 Teaching Assistant Training (TATr). *credit-awarding course that introduces essential teaching practices for new teaching assistants, tailored to the linguistics discipline. Four quarters in total, approximately four meetings per quarter. Fall 2020, 2021; Winter 2021, 2022.*

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

2021 – 2026 Teaching Assistant

University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Linguistics

◇ Syntax core courses and upper division

LING 112: Syntax I (Fall 2021, Spring 2023, Fall 2023)

LING 113: Syntax II (Winter 2024, Spring 2026)

LING 124: Language Typology (Fall 2024)

◇ Other core linguistics courses

LING 50: Introduction to Linguistics (Spring 2022)

LING 53: Semantics I (Winter 2025)

LING 100: Phonetics I (Winter 2022)

◇ Elective courses

LING 80C: Language, Society and Culture (Winter 2023)

LING 80M: Language and Indigeneity (Fall 2022)

LING 131: Spanglish (Summer 2022)

LING 80K: Intro to Invented Languages (Summer 2023, Spring 2024, Spring 2025)

2016 – 2019 **7th & 8th Grade Essay and Writing Tutor**
New York University, America Reads and Counts
The [Ella Baker School](#) (M225), New York, New York

MENTORSHIP EXPERIENCE

Undergraduate

- 2025 Ulysses Noë. UC Santa Cruz. *Experimental research on subject sub-extraction: pied-piping vs. p-stranding*. RAship funded by [UCSC Linguistics](#).
- 2024 – 2025 Matthew Vasser. UC Santa Cruz. *Experimental research on extraction from presuppositional DPs* (2024–2025). RAship funded by the [National Science Foundation](#). *Experimental research on sub-extraction: pied-piping vs. p-stranding* (2025). RAship funded by [UCSC Linguistics](#).
- 2024 Lisa Pham. UC Santa Cruz. *Experimental research on Subject Island effects*. RAship funded by the [National Science Foundation](#).
- 2023 – 2024 Alison Sun. UC Santa Cruz. *Corpus annotation of Sino-Korean event nouns* (2023). RAship funded by the [Tanya Honig Development Fund](#). *Experimental research on Subject Island effects* (2024). RAship funded by the [National Science Foundation](#).
- 2023 Seoleen Lee. UC Santa Cruz. *Corpus annotation of Sino-Korean event nouns*. RAship funded by the [Tanya Honig Development Fund](#).

High school

- 2026 Chloe Kim, Kaitlyn Ngo, and Alejandro Wasserman. *The history and grammatical consequence of Sino-Korean loanword integration*. Funded by the [Science Internship Program \(SIP\)](#).
- 2025 – 2026 Grace Guang, Tyler Chandran, Ananya Mallu. UC Santa Cruz. *The structure of verbs and their arguments in verb-final languages*. Funded by the [Science Internship Program \(SIP\)](#).
- 2022 Carey Chang, Hannah Chung, Josephine Chong, Akkshansh Bagga. UC Santa Cruz. *Code-mixing & multilingualism in Korean lyrics*. Funded by the [Science Internship Program \(SIP\)](#).
- 2021 Alaap Rag, Tyler Huang, Cansu Akkaynak. UC Santa Cruz. *Corpora statistics on pre-nominal elements in Korean*. Funded by the [Science Internship Program \(SIP\)](#).

RESEARCH POSITIONS

- 2025 **Graduate Student Researcher (GSR)**
University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Linguistics
PIs: [Matthew Kogan](#), [Nikolas Webster](#), [Matt Wagers](#), [Ivy Sichel](#)
Collaborative experimental research investigating pied-piping vs. p-stranding in English Subject Islands. GSR position included mentorship of two undergraduate RAs.

- 2024 **Graduate Student Researcher (GSR)**
University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Linguistics
PIs: [Nikolas Webster](#), [Matthew Kogan](#), [Mandy Cartner](#), [Matt Wagers](#), [Ivy Sichel](#)
Collaborative experimental research investigating Subject Island effects in large scale acceptability studies. GSR position included mentorship of three undergraduate RAs.
- 2021 **Graduate Student Researcher (GSR)**
University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Linguistics
PIs: [Jaye Padgett](#), [Ryan Bennett](#), [Grant McGuire](#). Reviewing, analyzing and correcting EdgTrack traces of tongue-body position of Irish and Russian palatized consonants.
- 2017 **Research Assistant (RA)**
New York University, Department of Linguistics
PIs: [Maria Gouskova](#), [Gillian Gallagher](#). Root and affix segmentation of Bolivian Quechua corpus, for research project on non-local phonological alternations.

SERVICE

To department

- 2021 – 2026 Equity in Linguistics ([EquiL](#)) Member & Organizer
A UC Santa Cruz graduate working group focusing on projects and events to foster diversity, equity, and inclusion within the department and field. Lead co-organizer 2022–2025.
- ◊ [First-year graduate student orientations](#) (Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025)
 - ◊ [Graduate student wellness & advising events](#) (Fall 2022, 2023, 2024, 2025; Spring 2023, 2025)
 - ◊ [Department-wide pedagogy development workshops](#) (Spring 2022, 2023, 2025; Winter 2023)
- 2023 – 2024 UC Santa Cruz Linguistics Graduate Representative
Attended faculty meetings, provided input on graduate student issues, and coordinated student activities related to recruitment and department job searches.
- 2020 – 2022 UC Santa Cruz Colloquium/Events Committee Member

To field

- 2025 – present Volunteer Proofreader - Language Science Press (LSP)
- 2025 – 2026 FASL35 Organizing Committee Member
The 35th Meeting of Formal Approaches to Slavic Linguistics, hosted by UC Santa Cruz
- 2023 – 2024 WCCFL41 Proceedings Volume Lead Editor
The 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, hosted by UC Santa Cruz
- 2023 WCCFL41 Conference Volunteer
The 41st West Coast Conference on Formal Linguistics, hosted by UC Santa Cruz
- 2022 HSP35 Conference Volunteer
The 35th Annual Conference on Human Sentence Processing, hosted by UC Santa Cruz

INDUSTRY EXPERIENCE

- 2019 – 2022 **Contracted Native EN Linguist**
[Defined.AI](#) via Upwork. Freelance consultant providing linguistics support, such as text-tagging for AI improvement, phonetic transcription, and text normalization.

AWARDS

Graduate career

- 2026 Jorge Hankamer Outstanding Graduate Instructor in Linguistics Award. University of California, Santa Cruz, Department of Linguistics. *In recognition of an outstanding record as a TA and contributions to the UCSC Linguistics pedagogical community.*
- 2025 – 2026 Presidential & Chancellor's Dissertation Fellowship, two quarters (\$22,000). University of California, Santa Cruz, Graduate Division.
- 2024, 2025 Grad Peer Mentor Program Funding Award (\$2500 first award; \$1100 second award). University of California, Santa Cruz, [The Graduate Student Commons](#). *In collaboration with fellow co-organizers of Equity in Linguistics (EquiL).*
- 2024 TLC Small Grants Funding Award (\$3000). University of California, Santa Cruz, [The Teaching & Learning Center](#). *In collaboration with fellow co-organizers of Equity in Linguistics (EquiL).*
- 2022, 2023 Humanities Division Summer Fellowship (\$3500 per award). University of California, Santa Cruz. *Summer funding for Ph.D. students in their 2nd and 3rd years.*
- 2020 – 2022 Graduate Student Success (G.S.S.) Fellowship (\$2500). University of California, Santa Cruz, [The Humanities Institute](#).
- 2020 – 2021 Regents' Fellowship (\$30,000). University of California, Santa Cruz. *Full year funding package for first-year Ph.D. students.*

Undergraduate career

- 2019 Robert A. Fowkes Prize for Excellence and Achievement in Linguistics. New York University, College of Arts and Sciences & Department of Linguistics. *In recognition of exemplary linguistic work completed by a graduating senior.*
- 2019 Summa cum laude (with highest distinction), New York University. *Graduation honors: GPA within the top 5% of the graduating class.*
- 2019 Elected to Phi Beta Kappa – Beta Chapter of New York
- 2015 – 2019 CAS Scholarship (\$28,970 per year). New York University, College of Arts and Sciences. *Four-year tuition coverage for exemplary scholars pursuing a degree in the humanities.*
- 2018 Nathan Sawaya Brick Artist Scholarship (\$3000). New York University. *Merit-based award.*
- 2018 Blume Family Scholarship (\$1000). New York University. *Merit-based award.*
- 2017, 2018 Gut Family Scholarship (\$5000 per award). New York University. *Merit-based award.*

- 2017 Dean's Opportunity Study Abroad Scholarship (\$1500). New York University. *Merit and needs-based award for undergraduates accepted for a summer abroad program.*
- 2017 Summer Liberal Studies Scholarship (\$1700). New York University. *Merit and needs-based award for undergraduates accepted for a summer abroad program.*
- 2016 Michael L. Probst Scholarship (\$2500). New York University. *Merit-based award.*

SKILLS

Languages

English (native), Korean (advanced),
German (intermediate), Turkish (beginner)

Programming

R, PCIBex, $\text{\LaTeX}$, Python, CSS and HTML

Software

Praat, RStudio, Microsoft 365,
Adobe Creative Suite (Photoshop, Illustrator, InDesign)